Burns

Types, dangers and providing first aid

Burns are injuries to the skin or tissues caused by heat, chemicals, electricity or radiation. They can range from mild to very severe and require prompt intervention to prevent complications.

Providing proper first aid in case of burns is essential for reducing pain and limiting tissue damage.

Types of burns

Burns can be classified according to their cause. The most common are thermal burns, caused by fire, hot liquids or heated objects. There are also chemical burns, caused by dangerous substances, as well as electrical burns, produced by electric current.

Burns can also be classified according to their severity. Superficial burns affect only the outer layer of the skin, while more serious burns can penetrate deeper and may affect internal tissues.

Manifestations and symptoms

Burns manifest themselves through redness, pain, swelling and, in some cases, the appearance of blisters. In severe cases, the skin may become white or charred.

The pain can be intense, and in severe situations states of shock or breathing difficulties may occur, especially if the airways are affected.

The dangers of burns

Burns can lead to serious complications, especially if they are extensive or deep. They can cause infections, loss of body fluids and impairment of vital functions. In severe cases, burns can be life-threatening and require urgent medical intervention.

First aid in case of burns

In the case of a burn, the first step is to remove the source of danger. The affected area must be cooled immediately with cold water for several minutes, in order to stop the burning process. Ice should not be applied directly to the skin, and creams, oils or other substances should not be used. If blisters are present, they must not be broken. The burned area should be covered with a clean and dry dressing. In the case of severe burns, the emergency services must be called.

What should be avoided

In the case of burns, certain actions can make the situation worse. Substances such as oil, butter or toothpaste must not be applied. Also, clothing stuck to the skin should not be pulled off, and the affected area should not be touched with dirty hands. Following these rules helps to prevent infections and complications.